Calendar

Combinatorics

Fall 2026

I will put all deadlines on the Blackboard Calendar. Please check it regularly.

Key university dates

For official University dates, see the Fall 2026 academic calendar and the Registrar's final-exam schedule.

Date	Event
Monday, August 17	Classes begin
Monday, September 7	Labor Day holiday
Tuesday, November 24–Friday, November 27	Thanksgiving holiday
Wednesday, December 9	Final exam: Wednesday, December 9, 2026, 8:00-10:00

Exams

Date	Assessment
Friday, September 18	Midterm 1
Friday, October 16 TENTATIVE	Midterm 2
Friday, November 13 TENTATIVE	Midterm 3
Wednesday, December 9, 2026, 8:00-10:00	Exam 4 and mastery reassessment

Daily lecture log

The public daily log below contains the lectures currently released. Later planning entries remain in the instructor's private lecture log and do not appear in this navigation.

Wk	Lec
1	**L1. Set notation and basic counting** 2026-08-17 **L2. Product rule and strings** 2026-08-19 **L3. More counting techniques** 2026-08-21
2	**L4. Applications of combinations and combinations with repetition** 2026-08-24 **L5. Review of choice models, increasing sequences, and basic binomial expansions** 2026-08-26 **L6. Polynomials, paths, Pascal recursion and restricted lattice paths, intro to inclusion–exclusio** 2026-08-28
3	**L7. Catalan paths and the inclusion–exclusion principle** 2026-08-31 **L8. Applications of inclusion–exclusion** 2026-09-02 **L9. Applications of inclusion–exclusion** 2026-09-04
4	**L10. Applications of inclusion–exclusion** 2026-09-09 **L11. Applications of inclusion–exclusion** 2026-09-11
5	**L12. Rook polynomials and forbidden positions** 2026-09-14 **Midterm 1** 2026-09-18
6	**L13. Ordinary generating functions: definitions and series multiplication** 2026-09-21 **L14. Ordinary generating functions: advanced techniques** 2026-09-23
7	**TODO: Friday 9/25** 2026-09-25 TENTATIVE **TODO: Monday 9/28** 2026-09-28 TENTATIVE **TODO: Wednesday 9/30** 2026-09-30 TENTATIVE **L18. Solving homogeneous linear recurrences with constant coefficients** 2026-10-02
8	**No class** 2026-10-05 **L19. Characteristic polynomials, repeated roots, and nonhomogeneous recurrences** 2026-10-07 **TODO: Friday 10/9** 2026-10-09 TENTATIVE
9	**TODO: Monday 10/12** 2026-10-12 TENTATIVE **L22. Finite state machines 2: recurrence relations and fast computation** 2026-10-14 **Midterm 2** 2026-10-16
10	**Fall break** 2026-10-19 **L23. Groups, symmetries of polygons, and permutations** 2026-10-21

TENTATIVE Lecture topics and assessment dates may change.

Week and unit overview

Weeks	Unit	Topic
1–4	Unit I: Enumeration	Counting models, bijections, double counting, and incl
4–5	Unit II: Generating-function foundations	Formal power series and ordinary generating-function
6–8 TENTATIVE	Unit III: Recurrences	State models, linear recurrences, recursive evaluation,
9–16 TENTATIVE	Further topics	To be announced